Urban Gardening: A Practical Guide

1. What Is Urban Gardening?

Urban gardening is the practice of growing plants, herbs, fruits, or vegetables in towns and cities. Plants can be grown on balconies, rooftops, windowsills, community plots, and other small spaces. It helps residents use available space to produce fresh food and create greener surroundings.

2. Choosing Containers

Containers should have drainage holes so excess water can escape. The container size depends on the plant. Leafy greens can grow in relatively shallow containers, while tomatoes need deeper pots and room for their roots.

3. Sunlight and Water

Most fruiting vegetables need several hours of direct sunlight each day. Leafy plants such as lettuce can tolerate partial shade. Water plants when the top layer of growing medium begins to feel dry, while avoiding waterlogged soil.

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4. Composting Kitchen Waste

Composting turns suitable organic waste into a soil-improving material. Fruit and vegetable scraps, dry leaves, and shredded uncoated paper can be composted. A good compost mix balances moist green materials with dry brown materials and allows air to circulate.

5. Common Plant Problems

Yellow leaves can be caused by overwatering, underwatering, nutrient deficiencies, or insufficient light. Inspect the plant and growing medium before changing its care routine. Remove badly damaged leaves and check regularly for pests.

6. Quick Knowledge Check

Question: Why should plant containers have drainage holes?

Answer: They allow excess water to escape and help prevent waterlogged roots.

Question: Name two materials suitable for a simple compost mix.

Answer: Fruit and vegetable scraps, and dry leaves.

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